

Aerial Miller

Composition 1

Professor Franke

9-28-2026

The movie inside out, Pixar persuades children to open up about their emotions, but mainly with joy in control of Riley' s life, showing how kids are always happy, however, joy being so in control disregards the other emotions Riley should show as well. All kids should be able to express their emotions, gain emotional regulation, and know that sadness is a good thing, not a bad thing. Throughout the movie, the writers use pathos to the audience for us to understand and regulate our emotions.

Joy's Control and Emotional Imbalance

Pixar uses Joy's dominance over Riley's emotions to show how children are often encouraged to stay happy, even when they feel other emotions that deserve to be expressed. Throughout the movie we see Joy ruling over Riley's memories to make them happy, no matter if it was a failure, a success, or a challenge. Watching it feels normal at first, because growing up, we're often told to "stay positive" and hide anything that isn't joyful. But with the constant "joyful" spirit the emotions had to surrender. The energy felt eerie and shifted when any other emotion wanted to react to a memory, especially sadness. Sadness keeps trying to be involved, which reflects how often we ignore our own sadness and try to cover it with a smile. As Joy's control starts to fail, the film

introduces Sadness as a crucial emotion, showing that balance, not constant happiness, is what truly helps Riley cope.

The Importance of Sadness

In the beginning of the movie, Sadness is portrayed as an annoying and disrespected emotion. However, throughout the movie the writers help the audience see the importance of sadness and how valuable it is to hold such an emotion. Through Sadness's role in the film, Pixar demonstrates that sadness is not a weakness but a necessary emotion that helps children process change and connect with others. In the movie, Joy expresses how she "doesn't understand what Sadness is for or why it's in Riley's head." Which many people don't, but that's why this movie portrayed sadness as important as she is. Sadness became a strong emotion that helped Riley make some of the decisions she made. This highlighted many of the audience to show how sadness isn't bad for us to go through in life, but it is difficult to use it in healthy ways. By learning to accept Sadness, Riley begins to understand that every emotion has a purpose, leading to emotional growth and maturity.

Emotional regulation and growth

By the end of *Inside Out*, the writers shape their main message of understanding all emotions throughout the movie. Riley, being in acceptance of all sadness to be fulfilled, symbolizes her emotional growth. The emotions soon begin to understand that sadness is relatable and is needed for Riley's youth. Riley controlling her emotions symbolizes

emotional regulation and teaches children that understanding every feeling leads to maturity and balance.

Even with all that, the writers maintain strong credibility throughout the film by grounding the story in real psychological concepts. Pixar's credibility becomes even clearer when you look at how the writers build the emotional foundation of the film. Inside Out doesn't just pick random feelings to represent Riley's inner world; it relies on five core emotions that psychologists widely recognize as universal human experiences. The five main emotions we all grow as a little kid, that complexes as we get older. Pixar uses Happiness, Anger, Fear, Disgust, and Sadness, which most psychologists study to learn more about people. Pixar uses the five core emotions because these specific emotions are rooted in developed psychological science regarding universal human expressions, while also keeping it simple for all ages to understand when watching the movie. Using these five core emotions keeps the science accurate while also making the movie simple enough for viewers of all ages to understand.

In conclusion, Pixar wanted the audience—kids and adults— to understand how important all five emotions are, but with a more acceptance of not always being joyful. Pixar having joy in main control emphasizes how many of us let happiness in control while suppressing our other emotions. Having the acceptance of sadness makes the audience learn maturity and growth within our emotions. Pixar created a strong pathos view on holding our emotions accountable, and it convinced all audiences of age, helping them

see how influential our own emotion and mood are. In addition, having strong credibility of the emotions being seen as our main emotions before anything else is also justified through studies of human emotions.

Works Cited

Four Lessons from “Inside Out” to Discuss With Kids. (n.d.). Greater Good.

https://greatergood.berkeley.edu/article/item/four_lessons_from_inside_out_to_discuss_with_kids

Stephens, A. (2018, April 25). *Is Pixar’s “Inside out” emotionally accurate?* Texas Standard.

<https://texasstandard.org/stories/is-pixars-inside-out-emotionally-accurate/>